

Ministry of Forests, Lands and Natural Resource Operations

BC River Forecast Centre

Flood Watch: Birkenhead River

High Streamflow Advisory: South Coast

UPDATE: 13 May 2013 11:15 AM

The BC River Forecast Centre is **maintaining** a **Flood Watch** for:

- Birkenhead River
- Depending on local rainfall amounts, other streams in the region may approach flood condition

The BC River Forecast Centre is **maintaining** a **High Streamflow Advisory** for:

- Lillooet River and tributaries
- Squamish River
- Tributary creeks through the Sea-to-Sky Corridor and Pemberton Valley

Snowmelt has been rapid over the past week as a result of unseasonably high temperatures. Rivers throughout the South Coast have been flowing high in response to this snow melt.

Additional rainfall is expected through Monday, with amounts in the range of 15-40 mm expected. Coastal areas (e.g. Squamish) are expected to receive higher rainfall amounts compared with more inland areas (e.g. Pemberton). Temperatures are forecast to cool through the next phase of precipitation overnight Monday and into Tuesday, and this should help to reduce snow melt rates.

A summary of current river levels in the region:

- Elaho River near the mouth (Water Survey of Canada 08GA071) reached 800 m³/s yesterday (between a 2-year and 5-year flow) and is currently dropping.
- Squamish River near Brackendale (08GA022) reached 1200 m³/s yesterday (2-year flow) and is currently dropping.
- Lillooet River near Pemberton (08MG005) reached 640 m³/s yesterday (between a 2-year and 5-year flow) and is currently dropping.
- Cheakamus River above Millar Creek (08GA072) is currently flowing at 82 m³/s (2-year flow) and dropping slightly.

A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.

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River levels will continue to drop slightly through Monday in advance of the next wave of precipitation. However, rapid additional rises are expected later Monday, with peak river levels expected into Tuesday. Flows in the Squamish, Lillooet and tributary rivers are expected to reach between 2-year and 10-year return period levels.

The River Forecast Centre will continue to monitor conditions and provide updates if conditions warrant.

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